

ILAYDA B. ONDER

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

2024 – Present | **Texas A&M University**
Assistant Professor of Political Science
Bush School of Government and Public Service

EDUCATION

2024 | **The Pennsylvania State University**
Ph.D. in Political Science
Fields: *International Relations, Political Methodology*
Dissertation: *Cooperation, Infighting, and Diffusion in Militant Group Networks*
– Winner of the USIP-Minerva Peace and Security Scholar Fellowship

2018 | **Koc University**
M.A. in International Relations
Fellowships: *TUBITAK MSc/MA Scholarship*

2016 | **Koc University**
M.A. in International Relations
Fellowships: *Semahat Arsel Scholar & Vehbi Koç Scholar*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I study political violence, rebellion, and civil war with a focus on (1) rebel-civilian ties, (2) rebel public communication, (3) multi-party conflicts, and (4) rebel intra-group politics.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

RC = Rebel-Civilian Ties | PC = Rebel Public Communication | MP = Multi-Party Conflicts | IG = Rebel Intra-Group Politics

*Indicates graduate student co-author.

- 12 | **Onder, Ilayda B., and Hongbi Choi***. 2026. “[Introducing the Rebel Internal Governance \(RIG\) Dataset.](#)” *International Studies Quarterly*. Accepted Pending Replication.^{IG}
- 11 | **Onder, Ilayda B.** 2026. “[A Principal-Agent Theory and Network Analysis of High-End Cooperation Among Militant Groups.](#)” *Political Science Research and Methods*. Accepted Pending Replication.^{MP, RC}
- 10 | Berlin, Mark, **Ilayda B. Onder**, and Joshua Fawcett Weiner. 2026. “[Leadership Succession and Jihadist Beheadings.](#)” *Journal of Global Security Studies*. Forthcoming.^{IG}

- 9 | Berlin, Mark, and Ilayda B. Onder. 2026. “Beyond Outbidding: Armed Group Responses to Transnational Jihadist Competition.” *Journal of Conflict Resolution*. Online First.^{MP}
- 8 | Onder, Ilayda B. 2026. “Quantitative Premises and Challenges in Studying the Kurdish Conflict in Turkey.” *PS: Political Science & Politics*. Forthcoming.^{RC, IG}
 – Invited peer-reviewed contribution to the symposium “The Clash of Methods in Studying Ethnic Conflict: Insights from the Kurdish Case”
- 7 | Amjad, Maria, Mark Berlin, Sara Daub, Ilayda B. Onder, and Joshua Fawcett Weiner. 2026. “Commanders of the Mujahideen: Introducing the Jihadist Leaders Dataset.” *Journal of Peace Research* 63(2): 289–297.^{IG}
- 6 | Onder, Ilayda B., and Mark Berlin. 2026. “We Have Nothing to Do with It: How Statements of Denial by Armed Actors Shape Public Perceptions and Emotions.” *Political Psychology* 47(3): e70079.^{PC}
- 5 | Onder, Ilayda B., Nazli Avdan, and Aaron M. Hoffman. 2025. “Credit Claims and the Survival Rates of Terrorist Organizations.” *International Interactions* 51(6): 1050–1066.^{PC}
- 4 | Onder, Ilayda B. 2025. “How Civilian Loyalties Shape Rebel-led Victimization of Rebel Constituencies.” *Journal of Conflict Resolution* 69(4): 701–730.^{RC}
- 3 | Loyle, Cyanne E., and Ilayda B. Onder. 2024. “The Legacies of Rebel Rule in Southeast Turkey.” *Comparative Political Studies* 57(11): 1771–1803.^{RC}
- 2 | Onder, Ilayda B. 2024. “Target Hardening and Non-State Armed Groups’ Target Selection: Evidence from India.” *Terrorism and Political Violence* 36(8): 1105–1126.^{MP}
- 1 | Onder, Ilayda B. 2023. “Signaling Resolve through Credit-claiming.” *International Interactions* 49(5): 755–784.^{PC}
 – Winner of the Raymond E. Lombra and Roberta Lombra Outstanding Graduate Research Award

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

RC = Rebel-Civilian Ties | PC = Rebel Public Communication | MP = Multi-Party Conflicts | IG = Rebel Intra-Group Politics

*Indicates graduate student co-author. **Indicates undergraduate student co-author.

Under Review/Submitted

- | Performative Rebel Governance and Legibility: Evidence from Rebel Recruitment in Southeast Turkey. Invited to revise & resubmit at the *American Political Science Review*.^{RC}
- | Kin-Soldier Martyrs and Incumbent Electoral Support in Rebel Constituencies: Evidence from Lottery-Based Conscription in Turkey.^{RC}
- | Right-Wing Populism and Counterterrorism Preferences: The Roles of Strongman Rule, Outgroup Attitudes, and Conspiratorial Thinking in Shaping Policy Support in the United States. (with James Piazza)^{PC}
- | Introducing the Rebel Lobbying Dataset (with Yu Bin Kim)^{PC}

In Progress

- | When Constituencies Unite but Recruitment Competition Divides: Cooperation and Infighting Among Armed Groups. *Draft in progress.*^{MP, RC}
- | Inter-Group Learning and Diffusion in Militant Alliances. *Draft in progress.*^{MP}
- | Civilian Victimization by Governance-Oriented Rebels. (with Hongbi Choi*) *Draft in progress.*^{IG, RC}
- | Repression of Rebel Constituencies and Rebel Recruitment. (with Muge Acarlar*) *Draft in progress.*^{RC}
- | Female Fighters and Rebel Compliance with International Humanitarian Law. (with Merve Keskin, Yu Bin Kim, and Blair Welsh) *Draft in progress.*^{PC, RC}
- | Kidnapping and the Consolidation of Rebel Rule: Evidence from Iraq and Syria, 2014–2016. (with Mark Berlin and Tim Jones) *Draft in progress.*^{RC}
- | Leadership Succession and Social Service Provision in Rebel Groups. (with Joshua Fawcett Weiner and Mark Berlin) *Draft in progress.*^{IG, RC}
- | Focusing on the Who: Rebel Governing Arrangements and International Legitimacy. (with Yu Bin Kim and Gidong Kim) *Data analysis in progress.*^{RC}
- | Part-Time Rebels. *Data analysis in progress.*^{RC, IG}
- | Opportunistic Rebel Violence against Civilians, How Groups Sanction It, and Foreign Public Opinion. (with Hongbi Choi*) *Data collection in progress.*^{IG}
- | Denial in Rebellion (with Mark Berlin and Kate Willey**) *Data collection in progress.*^{PC}
- | Inter-Group Mobility in Conflict. (with Finn Klebe) *Data collection in progress.*^{MP}

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS

Texas A&M University	
Bush School Seed Grant Program, \$11,990	2025
Glasscock Faculty Research Fellowship, \$5,000	2025
Scowcroft Faculty Research Grant Award, \$2,400	2025
The Empirical Studies of Conflict, Princeton University	
ESOC Mentorship Program, Non-monetary	2024 — 2025
Centre for the Comparative Study of Civil War, University of York	
Civil War Paths Fellow, Non-monetary	2024
USIP-Minerva Research Initiative	
Minerva Peace and Security Scholar Fellow, \$20,000	2023 — 2024
The Pennsylvania State University	
Lombra Outstanding Graduate Research Award, \$1,000	2024
Summer Graduate Research Award, \$16,000	2020 — 2023

Outstanding Political Science Graduate Student, \$1,500	2022
RGSO Dissertation Support, \$2,000	2021
Program in Empirical International Relations Fellowship, Assistantship Release	2021
Jesse M. MacKnight Memorial Graduate Scholarship, \$2,000	2018

TEACHING

Texas A&M University	
Introduction to Political Science Research (Undergraduate)	Fall 2024, Fall 2025
Ethnic Conflict (Undergraduate)	Spring 2026
Conflict Studies (Graduate)	Fall 2026
<i>Ph.D. Advisory and Dissertation Committees:</i> Hongbi Choi; Muge Acarlar; Julia Reyes; Santiago Vidal Calvo; Nathaniel Williams	
The Pennsylvania State University	
International Relations Theory (Undergraduate)	Spring 2024
Quantitative Political Analysis (Undergraduate)	Fall 2023
Graduate Methods Preceptor	Fall 2021 – Spring 2022

CONFERENCE, WORKSHOP, AND COLLOQUIUM PRESENTATIONS

American Political Science Association	2023, 2024
International Studies Association	2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
Junior Scholars in Quantitative Conflict Workshop	2023
Midwest Political Science Association	2019, 2023
NYU-CESS Experimental Political Science Conference	2024
Online Peace Science Colloquium	2021
Peace Science Society (International)	2020, 2021, 2023, 2025
Political Networks Online Colloquium	2023
Rabin Graduate Conference (Hebrew University of Jerusalem)	2017
Texas Triangle IR Conference	2025, 2026

INVITED TALKS AND WORKSHOPS

<i>The Clash of Methods in Studying Ethnic Conflict</i>	
Peace Science Conference, University of Central Florida	November 2025
<i>New Frontiers in Research on Terrorism and Civil Wars</i>	
University of Houston	March 2025
<i>Rising Scholars Workshop</i>	
Peace Science Conference, Washington University St. Louis	November 2023

DATASETS

Jihadist Leaders Dataset (JLD)	
Data on 31 biographical attributes of 238 leaders from 110 jihadist groups across Africa, Asia, and the Middle East between 1976 and 2023, drawing on Arabic, English, French, German, Turkish, and Urdu sources.	

Northeast Indian Militant Group Networks Dataset

Network dataset of 53 ethnonationalist militant groups active in Northeast India from 1981 through 2021, coding 8 forms of cooperation: joint operations, training, arms and funds, intelligence-sharing and logistical support, joint planning and meetings, joint public statements, umbrella organizations, and rhetorical support.

Civilian Victimization in the Kurdish Insurgency Dataset

572 incidents of the PKK's coercive acts, targeting or unintentionally harming civilian bystanders in 21 provinces in southeastern Turkey with significant Kurdish-speaking populations between 2014-2019, recording the characteristics of individuals (e.g., public worker, politician, alleged state informant, business owner).

Rebel Internal Governance (RIG) Dataset

(Forthcoming)

Time-variant data on 14 internal institutions and practices of 166 rebel groups across 57 countries between 1990 and 2012, capturing both written and de facto regulatory frameworks, judicial procedures, and disciplinary practices used to regulate fighter behavior.

Denial and Rebuttal in Rebellion Dataset

(In development)

Data public statements issued by rebel groups in the sub-Saharan African, Middle East and North Africa, in which they refute allegations (e.g., affiliations with other non-state actors, the arrests of their members, the killings of their leaders, involvement in criminal activities) made by governments or media outlets.

SERVICE

Departmental Service

Graduate & Curriculum Committee, Texas A&M University	2024–Present
Advisory Committee Graduate Student Rep., Penn State University	2023–2024
Graduate Student Association of Political Science, Penn State University	2019–2022

Chair/Discussant

American Political Science Association	2023
International Studies Association	2025, 2026
Texas Triangle IR Conference	2026

Workshop Organizer

Junior Scholars in Quantitative Conflict Workshop	2024–Present
Junior Scholars in International Security Workshop	2023–2024

Reviewer

American Journal of Political Science (x2), *American Political Science Review*, *Comparative Political Studies*, *Conflict Management and Peace Science* (x2), *Global Change, Peace & Security*, *International Interactions*, *International Studies Quarterly* (x3), *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, *Journal of Experimental Political Science*, *Journal of Global Security Studies*, *Journal of Peace Research* (x2), *Journal of Politics*, *Network Science* (x2), *Palgrave Macmillan*, *Political Science Research and Methods*, *Security Studies*.

PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS

American Political Science Association
International Studies Association
Peace Science Society (International)

Last updated: June 2, 2026